

Standard Chartered

Results mixed but mid-single-digit EPS upgrades expected in 2026 with 10% total yield

StanChart results are mixed with several moving parts including DPS 40% ahead of consensus, likely consensus mid-single-digit EPS upgrades in 2026 on stronger revenues, with management also outlining a strong start to 1Q across the business. We welcome the move to statutory ROTE now expected at >12% for 2026 and ahead of consensus 11.7%. The Group expects flat NII in 26E on a higher NII base, with total income growth at the bottom end of the 5-7% range on a c\$20.9bn revenue base in 2025, implying 2% upside to consensus forecasts for revenue (to c\$21.9bn). The Group also expects flat reported costs y/y at c\$13.3bn (broadly in line with cons including exceptional costs), with the underlying cost base +\$0.3bn higher on a like-for-like basis against previous targets, driven by more investment for growth and higher performance costs. We see updated guidance driving mid-single-digit upside to consensus PPOP forecasts for 26E. 4Q results showed a weaker non-NII performance driven by episodic income in Markets while Costs were also 4% higher than expected, but contained several one-offs (with underlying costs c1% higher). The Fit for Growth cost plan has been narrowed to c\$1.3bn (prev \$1.5bn) for both CTA/saves due to more attractive investment opportunities outside of the plan, with in-year cost savings of \$0.4bn/\$0.3bn expected in 26/27E. Overall, the Group has completed its 2024-26 plan a year earlier than targeted with its 5-7% income CAGR 24-26E achieved within 2 years, and we expect the positive trajectory of returns to grow from c12% statutory ROTE 2025 towards c14.5% 28E with new targets to be outlined in May. StanChart remains a top pick, trading at 8.9x PE, 1.2x PTNAV for an Adj ROTE of 14.2% 27E.

- **Noteworthy Areas:** 1) NII of \$2.95bn was 8% above cons and +8% q/q driven by a temporary improvement in CASA passthroughs with HIBOR +86bps in 4Q, and a timing benefit in treasury income. AIEAs were flat q/q with underlying loans +1% q/q driven by CIB loans +\$2bn q/q while WRB loans were flat q/q, and underlying deposits were +1% q/q driven by WRB (+\$6bn) partly offset by CIB deposits (-\$2bn q/q). 2) Other income of \$1.90bn was 11% below cons mainly driven by lower episodic income in Global Markets due to the timing of large client deals and market volatility impacting inventory held for client activity. Total income was \$4.85bn and 1% below cons. 3) Costs of \$3.43bn were 4% above cons and included \$121mn impact from the effect of higher share price on stock awards and one-off regulatory changes, driving PPOP of \$1.42bn 11% below cons. 4) Credit impairments of \$145m (14bps CoR) were below cons \$228m, driving underlying PBT of \$1.31bn 6% below cons, while Reported PBT of \$0.81bn was 23% below cons led by higher restructuring and other items vs cons. 5) CET1 of 14.1% was in line with RWAs 1% below cons; 6) DPS of \$0.49 was c40% ahead of cons \$0.35, SBBs of \$1.5bn were ahead of cons \$1.39bn. 7) TNAV/sh was \$17.30 vs cons \$17.35.
- **Outlook & Guidance:** Management notes that 1Q has started strong across the business. New guidance provided on a statutory basis vs underlying previously. **2026:** 1) New 2026 statutory RoTE guidance of >12% (cons

Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (23 Feb 26):1,816p

Price Target (Dec-27):2170.0p

European Banks

Kian Abouhossein ^{AC}

(44-20) 7134-4575

kian.abouhossein@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities plc

Sheel Shah, CFA

(44-20) 7134-8455

sheel.shah@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities plc

Venkat Madasu

(44-20) 3493-9041

venkat.madasu@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities plc

Katherine Lei

(852) 2800-8552

katherine.lei@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/ J.P. Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Lincoln Yu

(852) 2800 8523

lincoln.yu@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/ J.P. Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Specialist Sales contact details:

Gigi Sparling - Specialist Sales - European Financials

(44-20) 7134-0355

ghislaine.sparling@jpmorgan.com

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11.7%). 2) Reported income growth to be around the bottom end of 5-7% (const-fx, ex notables), implying 2026E revenues of \$21.9bn (c2% above cons at \$21.5bn), with NII flat at c\$11.2bn which implies non-NII growth of c11% y/y. 3) Reported costs to be broadly flat y/y (const-fx, ex notables) implying 2026E costs of \$13.3bn (in line with cons at \$13.23bn). 4) Fit-for-growth restructuring costs and gross cost saves (both included in reported cost guidance) to be \$1.3bn (vs \$1.5bn before). FFG will end in 2026 (as guided) with zero restructuring costs in 2027. Ventures segment will now be reported across WRB (Digital Banks) and Central (SCV). Medium-term targets to be provided in May'26.

- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX):** 4Q: Global Markets -15% y/y (17% below cons) with Macro -24% y/y and Credit flat y/y; Global Markets Flow income (+9% y/y) more than offset by negative episodic income (-\$16m in Q4 25 vs \$154m in Q4 24). Global Banking +7% y/y (1% below cons) with Lending & Fin Solutions +9% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory -5% y/y. Wealth +20% y/y (2% below cons) with \$10bn net new money (\$52bn in 2025 equivalent to 14% growth of AUM, compared to c\$200bn 5Y target from 2025) and c75k new-to-bank affluent clients onboarded (c275k in 2025 and consistently >60k clients per quarter).
- **Likely changes to consensus:** We expect mid-single-digit upside to consensus PPOP forecasts for 26E driven by stronger revenues with consensus stated costs in line. We see the potential for upgrades to consensus 2027 PPOP on continued revenue growth, although partly offset by investments and inflation.
- **Peer read-across:** We see these results as a positive read-across for HSBC's Wealth revenues with StanChart Wealth income growth of +20% y/y in 4Q alongside net new money of \$10bn (inc. \$6bn in Wealth) at c9% inflow rate in 4Q, and a strong outlook for non-NII growth of c11% y/y in 2026E.
- **Conference Call Details:** 08.00 UK [here](#)

Actual vs Expected:

Table 1: StanChart 4Q Group results

\$mn

	4Q24	3Q25	4Q25E	4Q25 Cons	4Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,977	2,737	2,771	2,742	2,949	8%	6%	-1%	8%
Other Income	1,832	2,410	2,045	2,142	1,899	-11%	-7%	4%	-21%
Revenue	4,809	5,147	4,816	4,884	4,848	-1%	1%	1%	-6%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,666	1,488	1,462	1,485	1,521	2%	4%	-9%	2%
o.w. Global Banking	500	588	558	549	545	-1%	-2%	9%	-7%
o.w. Global Markets	773	848	796	791	660	-17%	-17%	-15%	-22%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	562	890	686	689	677	-2%	-1%	20%	-24%
Operating expenses	-3,277	-2,953	-3,326	-3,286	-3,429	4%	3%	5%	16%
Pre-provision operating profit	1,532	2,194	1,491	1,598	1,419	-11%	-5%	-7%	-35%
Loan impairments	-130	-195	-212	-228	-145	-36%	-32%	12%	-26%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	1,402	1,999	1,279	1,370	1,274	-7%	0%	-9%	-36%
Other impairments	-353	-20	-4	-47	-13	-72%	225%	-96%	-35%
Profit from associates	-27	6	8	-9	-26	189%	-425%	-4%	-533%
Clean Pretax profits	1,022	1,985	1,283	1,314	1,235	-6%	-4%	21%	-38%
Total one-offs	-222	-219	-342	-257	-421	64%	23%	90%	92%
Pretax profits	800	1,766	941	1,057	814	-23%	-13%	2%	-54%
DPS	0.28	-	0.34	0.35	0.49	41%	43%	75%	-
Underlying RoTE	8.1%	13.4%	8.0%	8.5%	9.6%				
TNAV/s	\$15.41	\$16.84	\$17.30	\$17.35	\$17.30	0%	0%	12%	3%
CET1 ratio	14.2%	14.2%	14.0%	14.1%	14.1%				
RWAs	247	258	262	261	258	-1%	-1%	4%	0%
Loans (amortised cost)	281	285	288	288	287	0%	0%	2%	1%
Customer deposits	464	526	528	516	530	3%	0%	14%	1%
SBB	1500	-	1500	1390	1500	8%	0%	0%	-

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 2: StanChart 4Q product revenues

\$mn

	4Q24	3Q25	4Q25E	4Q25 Cons	4Q25A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,666	1,488	1,462	1,485	1,521	2%	4%	-9%	2%
Payments and Liquidity	1,193	1,016	1,008	1,017	1,065	5%	6%	-11%	5%
Securities Services	161	166	167	164	173	5%	4%	7%	4%
Trade & Working Capital	312	306	287	304	283	-7%	-1%	-9%	-8%
Banking	500	588	558	549	545	-1%	-2%	9%	-7%
Lending & Financial Solutions	434	496	488	474	481	1%	-1%	11%	-3%
Capital Market & Advisory	66	92	70	75	64	-15%	-9%	-3%	-30%
Markets	773	848	796	791	660	-17%	-17%	-15%	-22%
Macro Trading	654	678	634	642	499	-22%	-21%	-24%	-26%
Credit Trading	138	206	158	157	138	-12%	-13%	0%	-33%
Valuation & Other Adj	-19	-36	4	-5	23				
Wealth Solutions	562	890	686	689	677	-2%	-1%	20%	-24%
Investment Products	452	691	572	553	553	0%	-3%	22%	-20%
Bancassurance	110	199	114	122	124	2%	8%	13%	-38%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	270	277	262	271	264	-3%	1%	-2%	-5%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,058	1,034	1,015	1,041	1,050	1%	3%	-1%	2%
Ventures	60	39	52	54	56	4%	8%	-7%	44%
Digital Banks	41	49	52	51	58		-	-	-
SCV	19	-10	0	4	-2		-	-	-
Treasury & Other	-80	-17	-15	-6	75		-	-	-
Total underlying operating income	4,809	5,147	4,816	4,874	4,848				

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (Overweight; Price Target: 2170.0p)

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to the sector/EM peers at 1.3x PTNAV 27E with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. We expect a c7% revenue growth CAGR across '23-26E driven by non-NII led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities) and Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income), with the Group's previous investments producing revenue momentum. We expect NII to decline by 1% in FY26E with lower rates and pass throughs offset by volume growth, management actions (e.g. growth in higher margin areas) and a growing hedge. We expect cost growth at a c4% CAGR, with the Group's restructuring programme expected to drive material cost saves from FY26E, supporting PPOP CAGR of 13% and RoTE growing to 14.2%/14.7% in 27/28E. Capital remains strong and we forecast buybacks of \$2bn annually from 26E alongside a 35% dividend payout ratio.

Valuation

We value StanChart using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 8.5x P/E, and Consumer, Private & Business Banking Commercial at 9.5x P/E, and Ventures at 1x book. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-27 PT is 2,170p.

Standard Chartered: SOP-based Valuation

£ MILLION Division	Post Tax Profit 2028E	Allocated B4 Equity 2028E	RWAs £ bn 2028E	Valuation Basis	£ mn Value	£ Per Share	(x) PE	(x) P/BV
Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking	3,670	20,412	157.0	P/E	31,198	15.46	8.5	
Consumer, Private and Business Banking	2,135	6,779	52.1	P/E	20,282	10.05	9.5	
Ventures	-86	709	5.5	P/B	709	0.35		1.0
Corporate centre and other	-732	3,047	23.4	P/E	-6,589	-3.26	9.0	
Capital Excess		2,578		1 times BV	2,578	1.28		1.0
Standard Chartered Group	4,987	33,524	238.0		48,177	23.9	9.7	
Standard Chartered Group (Dec-2027)						21.7		

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross border and political risks. COVID-19 continues to be a risk towards revenues and impairments in the near term, particularly in Asian economies, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions at normalised levels across the medium term given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.

- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to changes in the regulatory environment in the UK, with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the Group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 23 February 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

HSBC Holdings plc(HSBA.L/1,293p/N)

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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
27-Feb-23	OW	771	1,000
17-Apr-23	OW	646	970
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690
03-Nov-25	OW	1560	1,770
02-Dec-25	OW	1681	1,880
05-Feb-26	OW	1857	2,170

HSBC Holdings plc (HSBA.L, HSBA LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
27-Feb-23	N	636	650
17-Apr-23	N	584	630
07-Jul-23	N	610	680
16-Oct-23	N	653	690
16-Jan-24	N	596	660
22-Feb-24	N	590	600
10-Apr-24	N	645	660
01-May-24	N	696	700
15-Nov-24	N	706	730
06-Dec-24	N	751	780
20-Feb-25	N	895	900
20-Mar-25	N	896	920
01-May-25	N	832	830
01-Aug-25	N	923	870
09-Sep-25	N	970	940
17-Oct-25	N	989	950
29-Oct-25	N	1050	1,010
02-Dec-25	N	1080	1,060
05-Feb-26	N	1308	1,190

The chart(s) show J.P. Morgan's continuing coverage of the stocks; the current analysts may or may not have covered it over the entire period. J.P. Morgan ratings or designations: OW = Overweight, N= Neutral, UW = Underweight, NR = Not Rated

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